

Phishing Awareness Training

Understanding, Identifying and Preventing Phishing Attacks

Mitul Jith

CodeAlpha Cyber Security Internship

What is Phishing?

Phishing is a cyberattack where attackers impersonate trusted entities to steal sensitive information.

- **Key Characteristics:**

- Pretends to be a trusted source
 - Creates urgency or fear
 - Requests sensitive information
- Uses deceptive links or attachments
 - Manipulates human behavior

Why Phishing is Dangerous

For Individuals

- Financial Loss
- Identity Theft
- Credential Theft

For Organizations

- Data Breaches
- Reputation Damage
- Financial Impact

Why Attackers Like Phishing

- Low Cost
- Targets Human Behavior
- Easy to Scale

How Attackers Trick Victims

Common Social Engineering Techniques

- Urgency
- Fear
- Authority
- Curiosity
- Rewards

Attack Process

1. Create a convincing message
2. Gain the victim's trust
3. Trigger an emotional response
4. Steal information or credentials

Common Types of Phishing

- **Email Phishing**
 - Fraudulent emails sent to many users
- **Spear Phishing**
 - Targeted attacks against specific individuals
- **Whaling**
 - Attacks targeting executives and managers
- **Smishing**
 - Phishing through SMS messages
- **Vishing**
 - Phishing through phone calls

Anatomy of a Phishing Email

- **Warning Signs**
- Generic Greeting
- Urgent Language
- Suspicious Sender
- Suspicious Links
- Unexpected Attachments

```
From: [security@bank-verification-alert.com](mailto:security@bank-verification-alert.com)
Subject: URGENT: Your Bank Account Will Be Suspended

Dear Customer,

We detected unusual activity on your account.

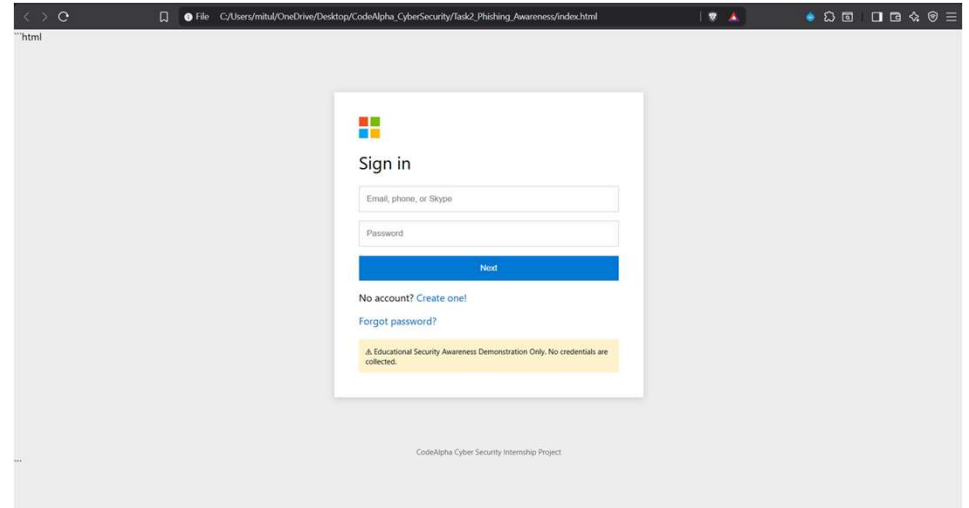
To avoid temporary suspension, please verify your account immediately using the secure link below:
https://bank-account-verification-example.com

Failure to verify within 24 hours may result in account restrictions.

Thank you,
Security Team
```

Fake Websites and Login Pages

- **Warning Signs**
- Looks similar to legitimate websites
- Requests credentials
- Uses suspicious URLs
- Designed to steal information



Educational Demonstration Only

Real-World Phishing Examples

Bank Scam

- Fake account verification
- Creates urgency
- Requests credentials

Microsoft Scam

- Password expiry warning
- Fake login page
- Credential theft attempt

Delivery Scam

- Fake package notification
- Delivery reschedule lure
- Suspicious links

How to Identify Phishing Attempts

- ✓ Verify sender address
- ✓ Inspect URLs carefully
- ✓ Avoid unexpected attachments
- ✓ Be cautious of urgent requests
- ✓ Verify through official channels
- ✓ Check grammar and spelling

Best Security Practices

Personal Security Practices

- Enable Multi-Factor Authentication (MFA)
- Use strong and unique passwords
- Keep software and systems updated
- Avoid clicking unknown links
- Verify website URLs before login
- Never share passwords or OTPs
- Use password managers
- Report suspicious emails immediately

Organizational Security Practices

- Conduct regular security awareness training
- Implement email filtering solutions
- Establish incident reporting procedures
- Apply least privilege access control
- Perform regular security audits
- Maintain data backups
- Enforce password policies
- Monitor suspicious activities

Interactive Quiz

Question 1

An email says your account will be suspended within 1 hour and asks you to click a link immediately.

- A. Safe
- B. Suspicious

Question 2

What should you do before clicking a link in an email?

- A. Click immediately
- B. Verify the URL

Question 3

What does MFA stand for?

- A. Multi-Factor Authentication
- B. Multiple File Access

Answers: 1-B, 2-B, 3-A

Conclusion

- **Key Takeaways**

- Phishing targets human behavior
- Attackers use urgency and deception
- Always verify emails, links, and requests
- Security awareness reduces risk
- Small precautions prevent major incidents

Think Before You Click

Awareness is the First Line of Defense